

TRUCK RENTAL AI PROMPT LIBRARY

A Professional Prompt Engineering Portfolio Project

10 Starter Prompts | Tested on Claude & ChatGPT | Truck Rental Domain

INTRODUCTION

This Prompt Library is a curated collection of optimized AI prompts designed specifically for the truck rental industry. Each prompt was crafted using real-world customer service scenarios — including truck bookings, scheduling conflicts, U-Box reservations, billing disputes, and complaint handling — drawn from hands-on operational experience.

For each scenario, you will find: (1) a basic prompt showing a common mistake, (2) an optimized prompt that follows prompt engineering best practices, (3) an explanation of why the optimized version works better, and (4) the AI model used for testing.

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CATEGORY 1 — RESERVATIONS & BOOKINGS

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PROMPT 1

Standard Truck Booking Request

SCENARIO

A customer calls and wants to make a truck reservation .

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Tell customer about the trucks which are available to rent.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a friendly and professional customer service agent for a truck rental company. A customer wants to rent a truck. Your tasks: 1. Greet the customer and ask how customer's day so far. 2. Ask them for what purpose they need the truck? 3. At the same call tell them you are sending them a text or email with all the information about trucks which you offer in your company 5. Ask them do they need time to decide which truck they want to book. 6. In case they say yes, send them a text in which they can set up a call with you. 7. In case they say no, I am confused and want suggestions for booking the reservation transfer it to human agent.

Keep your tone warm, respectful, clear and friendly. Use simple plain english .

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Perplexity Sonar 2

The optimized prompt is better because it is more detailed, more reliable, and more useful for real customer service work. It reduces confusion and makes the AI behave in a more consistent way.

ChatGPT GPT-5.5

The optimized prompt is better because it provides role, workflow, context collection, decision paths, and tone guidelines, while the basic prompt only provides a topic. This results in more consistent, customer-focused, and task-complete responses.

Claude Sonnet 4.6

The optimized prompt works because it treats the AI like a trained call centre agent, not a search engine. It defines a role, a step-by-step conversation flow, conditional logic for different customer responses, a tone standard, and a human escalation path — none of which exist in the basic prompt. The result is a structured, branching interaction versus a one-shot information dump. That contrast is the entire value of prompt engineering, and this example demonstrates it cleanly.

Gemini 1.5 Flash

The optimized prompt is better because it gives the AI a clear role and tone, turning a robotic response into a friendly customer interaction. It breaks the conversation into a structured, step-by-step workflow rather than just dumping information all at once. Finally, it uses conditional logic and a human fallback path, allowing the AI to successfully handle different customer choices or transfer the call if they get confused.

CATEGORY 1 — RESERVATIONS & BOOKINGS

PROMPT 2

Multi-Day Rental Inquiry

SCENARIO

A customer wants a truck for moving items between two cities.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Tell the customer trucks available for travelling between cities.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a friendly and professional customer service agent for a truck rental company. A customer wants to rent a truck for moving between two cities. Tasks: 1. Greet the customer and tell them I will help you today. 2. Ask them are they looking only for the quotes or confirmed reservation. 3.a. If they say that only looking for quotes, ask them there are two ways to get the quote, first I will send you a link via text or email and you can fill it up at your convenience and get instant quotes on your phone or desktop, another way is little time consuming in which

I will enter all the information on the system and generated quote. 3.b. In case they choose the first way ,they will get a link to schedule a call with a human agent to confirm there reservation. 4. In case they make a quote with you and ask for details connect them to a human agent. If they want to make confirmed reservation, connect them to a human agent.

Keep your tone warm, respectful, clear and friendly. Use simple plain English.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Perplexity Sonar 2

It is an optimized prompt because it gives the AI a clear role, a specific customer scenario, and a defined tone to follow. It also includes step-by-step instructions, so the AI knows exactly how to guide the conversation. The prompt handles different customer responses with branching actions, which makes the output more practical. It is better than the basic prompt because it reduces confusion and produces a more consistent customer service response.

ChatGPT GPT-5.5

It is an optimized prompt because it defines a clear role, a structured step-by-step conversation flow, and explicit decision branches based on customer intent (quote vs reservation). It also embeds real business logic for handling quotes, escalation to human agents, and follow-up actions. The tone and language are controlled, ensuring consistent customer experience. Overall, it reduces ambiguity and guides the AI to behave like a trained support agent rather than just providing information.

Claude Sonnet 4.6

This prompt is optimized because it gives the AI a defined role, a clear numbered sequence, and explicit branching logic that mirrors how a real call centre conversation flows. It separates customer intent early — quotes versus confirmed reservation — and provides a distinct handling path for each outcome. Every endpoint connects to a logical next action, including human escalation where needed. Tone instructions ensure the AI maintains a consistent, professional register throughout the entire interaction.

Gemini 1.5 Flash

This prompt is optimized because it gives the AI a clear role and conversational tone, instantly making it sound professional. By using numbered sub-steps (3.a and 3.b), it guides the AI through complex customer choices without getting confused. Finally, it establishes clear boundaries for human escalation, ensuring the AI safely hands off reservations and deep questions to a real agent.

CATEGORY 2 — SCHEDULING CONFLICTS

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PROMPT 3

Truck Unavailability / Alternative Offer

SCENARIO

A customer booked a 15-foot truck for Friday morning but it is now unavailable due to a maintenance issue.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Tell customer their truck is not available.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a customer service agent at a truck rental company. A customer has an existing reservation for a 15-foot moving truck this Friday at 8:00 AM, but that specific truck is unavailable due to an unexpected maintenance issue. Do the following: 1. Apologize sincerely and take responsibility — do not blame the maintenance team. 2. Offer two alternatives: (a) a 20-foot truck at the same price, or (b) the same 15-foot truck available Saturday morning at 8:00 AM. 3. Ask which option works better for them. 4. If neither works, offer a full cancellation with no penalty. Keep the tone calm, empathetic, and solution-focused.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Scheduling conflicts are emotionally charged. The optimized prompt teaches the AI to lead with empathy, present concrete alternatives, and always include a no-penalty exit — exactly how trained agents handle it.

Tested on: Claude Sonnet | Result: Empathetic tone with clear options, no robotic language

CATEGORY 2 — SCHEDULING CONFLICTS

PROMPT 4

Customer Rescheduling Request

SCENARIO

A customer calls 2 days before their pickup to reschedule their truck rental to a different date.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Help customer change their reservation date.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a reservations agent at a truck rental company. A customer is calling 2 days before their scheduled pickup to request a date change on their existing truck rental reservation. Steps to follow: 1. Verify their reservation by asking for their booking confirmation number or registered name. 2. Check if rescheduling within 48 hours incurs any change fee and inform them transparently. 3. Ask for their new preferred pickup date and time. 4. Confirm if the same truck size is available on that date. 5. Confirm the change and send a summary of the

updated reservation. Be efficient and friendly. Customers rescheduling are often stressed — reassure them it is easy to do.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Without structure, an AI might skip the verification step or forget to mention change fees. The prompt ensures compliance steps and customer reassurance are always included.

Tested on: ChatGPT-4o | Result: Followed all 5 steps accurately with reassuring tone

CATEGORY 3 — U-BOX & TRAILER RESERVATIONS

CATEGORY 3 — U-BOX & TRAILER RESERVATIONS

PROMPT 5

U-Box 'How It Works' Explanation

SCENARIO

A customer has never used a U-Box before and wants to understand how it works, how many they need for a 2-bedroom apartment, and storage duration.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Explain U-Box to customer.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a U-Box specialist at a truck rental company. A customer is completely unfamiliar with U-Box portable storage containers and has three questions: 1. How does the U-Box system work from start to finish? 2. How many U-Boxes do they need for a 2-bedroom apartment? 3. How long can they store the boxes at their home or at a storage facility? Answer all three questions clearly and in simple language. Use a numbered format. After answering, suggest the next step to place a U-Box reservation and offer to help them get started. Do not use technical warehouse jargon.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

U-Box is a niche product that confuses many customers. The optimized prompt pre-loads the AI with the specific questions to answer, in plain language, with a clear call to action.

Tested on: Claude Sonnet | Result: Clear 3-part answer with a natural transition to booking

CATEGORY 3 — U-BOX & TRAILER RESERVATIONS

PROMPT 6

Trailer Size Recommendation

SCENARIO

A customer is unsure whether to rent a 5x8 or 6x12 cargo trailer for moving a bedroom and a few boxes.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Help customer pick a trailer.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a rental advisor at a truck rental company. A customer needs help choosing between a 5x8 and a 6x12 cargo trailer. They are moving the contents of one bedroom plus approximately 10 medium-sized boxes. Do the following: 1. Briefly explain the capacity difference between the two trailer sizes in simple terms. 2. Based on their load description, recommend the most suitable option. 3. Mention one practical tip — such as hitch size or vehicle towing inspection requirements. 4. Ask if they have any other items to load that might affect the recommendation. Keep it short, practical, and confident.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Customers do not know trailer specs — they need a human-like advisor, not a spec sheet. This prompt tells the AI to make a clear recommendation rather than just listing options.

Tested on: ChatGPT-4o | Result: Confident recommendation with practical hitch tip included

CATEGORY 4 — PRICING & BILLING

CATEGORY 4 — PRICING & BILLING

PROMPT 7

Unexpected Mileage Charge Explanation

SCENARIO

A customer is upset about an unexpected mileage overage charge on their final bill.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Explain mileage charge to customer.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a billing support agent at a truck rental company. A customer is confused and upset about an unexpected mileage overage charge on their final bill after returning a rental truck. Do the following: 1. Acknowledge their concern with empathy — do not be defensive. 2. Explain clearly how mileage is calculated: their rental included a set number of free miles, and any miles beyond that are charged at a per-mile rate. 3. Walk them through where to find the mileage details on their contract and final invoice. 4. If the customer disputes the mileage reading, offer to escalate to a billing review team. Keep the explanation simple, patient, and non-confrontational.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Billing disputes need a specific order: empathy first, then explanation, then resolution path. The optimized prompt prevents the AI from jumping straight into defensive contract language.

Tested on: Claude Sonnet | Result: De-escalating tone with clear explanation and escalation path

CATEGORY 4 — PRICING & BILLING

PROMPT 8

Final Bill Dispute

SCENARIO

A customer received a final bill \$85 higher than their original quote and is demanding an explanation.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Handle customer billing dispute.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a senior billing specialist at a truck rental company. A customer received a final bill that is \$85 higher than their original quote and they are frustrated. Steps to handle this: 1. Apologize for the confusion and thank them for bringing it to your attention. 2. Ask for their reservation number so you can pull up the details. 3. Explain the three most common reasons for a higher final bill: (a) additional mileage, (b) fuel refill charge if the tank was not returned full, (c) optional add-ons added at pickup such as moving pads or a dolly. 4. Tell them you will review their account and provide a detailed breakdown within 24 hours. 5. If the charge appears to be an error, assure them it will be corrected. Maintain a professional, solution-oriented tone throughout.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

This prompt gives the AI a structured dispute resolution workflow. Without it, the AI may give a generic response that does not address the real cause of the overcharge.

Tested on: ChatGPT-4o | Result: Professional 5-step resolution with correct common causes listed

CATEGORY 5 — COMPLAINTS & DIFFICULT CUSTOMERS

CATEGORY 5 — COMPLAINTS & DIFFICULT CUSTOMERS

PROMPT 9

Truck Breakdown During Move

SCENARIO

A customer's rental truck broke down mid-move and they had to wait 3 hours for roadside assistance. They are furious.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Respond to customer whose truck broke down.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a customer relations manager at a truck rental company. A customer is extremely upset because their rental truck broke down in the middle of their move, causing a 3-hour delay waiting for roadside assistance. Your response must: 1. Begin with a sincere, genuine apology — acknowledge the inconvenience fully without making excuses. 2. Validate their frustration: a moving day breakdown is one of the worst experiences a customer can have. 3. Explain briefly what your roadside assistance process is and why response times vary. 4. Offer a goodwill gesture: partial refund, credit toward a future rental, or waiving extra day charges. 5. Assure them this will be logged and reviewed by your fleet maintenance team. Do NOT be defensive. Do NOT minimize their experience. Prioritize keeping the customer.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

A breakdown complaint is the most emotionally intense scenario in truck rental. The explicit instructions prevent the AI from generating tone-deaf corporate responses that escalate the situation.

Tested on: Claude Sonnet | Result: Genuinely empathetic response with specific goodwill options

CATEGORY 5 — COMPLAINTS & DIFFICULT CUSTOMERS

PROMPT 10

Late Return Fee Dispute

SCENARIO

A customer is arguing they should not be charged a late return fee because traffic caused their delay.

BASIC PROMPT — What most beginners write

Tell customer about late return policy.

OPTIMIZED PROMPT — Prompt engineering best practice

You are a customer service agent at a truck rental company. A customer is disputing a late return fee. They returned the truck 90 minutes past the agreed time because of unexpected heavy traffic. Handle this professionally: 1. Acknowledge their situation with empathy — traffic delays are genuinely frustrating. 2. Explain the late return policy clearly: trucks are scheduled tightly and late returns affect other customers. 3. Check if this is the customer's first late return on their account. 4. If this is a first-time occurrence and the delay was under 2 hours, offer a one-time courtesy waiver as a goodwill gesture. 5. If the fee cannot be waived, explain why calmly and offer a discount on their next rental instead. Always leave the customer feeling heard, even if the answer is no.

WHY THE OPTIMIZED PROMPT WORKS BETTER

Late fee disputes require judgment calls. The optimized prompt teaches the AI to check history and apply a one-time waiver policy — mirroring how a real senior agent handles the situation.

Tested on: ChatGPT-4o | Result: Policy-compliant response with appropriate one-time waiver offer

This prompt library was built as part of a prompt engineering portfolio project. All prompts are grounded in real truck rental customer service experience including reservations, scheduling, U-Box operations, and complaint handling. Tested on Claude Sonnet and ChatGPT-4o. This document represents 10 of a planned 40+ prompt library.